

Founder Bottleneck Diagnostic

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The short version

One 90-minute session to find the real thing holding a founder back. Not advice. Not a strategy deck. One session to name the actual constraint and the one move to make next.

Most founders come in sure they already know the problem. "My team is slow." "My marketing isn't working." "I can't focus." Usually that's the symptom. The session finds the cause. Surface complaint rarely equals the real bottleneck.

Who's behind it

I'm Trung. Before this I spent 10+ years in engineering and infrastructure, including Contentful and Workpath. As infra lead at Workpath, the foundations my team built let the company scale to six product teams shipping at the same time.

I'm not a coach and not a generalist consultant. My background is systems, theory of constraints, security and infra. I do for a founder and their company the same thing I used to do for broken systems: find where it's actually stuck, not where it looks stuck.

A peer from that time said it well:

"Trung excels at seeing the big picture for our team and where we can and should focus our resources. A great sparring partner for any kind of topic."

Martin, engineering peer at Workpath

Who it's for

Founders running something real that's starting to crack:

- 3 to 30 people, past MVP, a year or more in
- Has revenue or real users
- Quietly suspects they've become the bottleneck
- Can feel something is off but can't name it

Two flavors of the same problem:

- Operators: team feels slow, priorities everywhere, founder stuck inside their own machine
- Scalars: just raised or just started spending, about to hire, scared of an expensive mistake they can't see yet

The quick test for whether someone's a fit: are they confidently wrong about their own bottleneck, and clearly stuck? That's who this helps most.

Who it's not for

- Idea stage, no team or product yet
- Anyone who wants validation or a cheerleader
- Anyone looking for ongoing coaching. This is one bounded session, on purpose

Does it actually work

Fair question, especially if we haven't worked together. A few real ones:

"Your question-asking approach helped me save 10 to 15 hours of nonsense outreach."

Minh, founder of Algomate

"It's like going to the doctor to get a scan you've never had before and you find out problems you didn't know you had."

Founder, early-stage public speaking platform (the result landed six months after the session, not the same week)

"You are good at laying things out on a table, like a puzzle, helping someone articulate and see the next necessary steps. There's never any awkwardness, no games."

Chris, founder of mindtv (we didn't end up working together, he said this seven months later)

"You already know something, but it hits when someone says it to you straight. Sometimes you just need to take your medicine."

Johny Harris, founder of Dai Viet Rugby

What you walk out with

- The one thing to stop doing, named plainly
- 1 to 3 real priorities instead of a vague list
- A decision you'd been putting off, made
- The number or fact you'd been avoiding, in front of you

The value is in the naming, not in a 40-page plan. You should be able to repeat it to your co-founder in one sentence.

How it works

Remote, 90 minutes. Pricing is value-based and set in the conversation, not before it. If you want to feel it out first, a short coffee chat is free, no pitch.

If this sounds like someone you know, forward it. If it's you, reach out and we'll see if it's a fit. And if it's not a fit, I'll tell you straight. That's kind of the whole point.

Live version: iamtrung.com/d/diagnostic-handout